

TalisMan v1 — Founder Audit

Package

Part 1 of 3 · Progress recap · 2026-06-19 · Baseline (first audit package)

What TalisMan is

A local-first, **approval-gated AI orchestration system**: it coordinates Claude Code and Codex CLI as worker agents to carry projects through a governed "spiral" (discovery → plan → review → ...), pausing at human-approval gates and enforcing cost and security boundaries. The design principle throughout is **gated autonomy** — it works unattended until a decision, a budget event, or an incident needs a human.

How it was built — the meta-story

TalisMan was built **by its own governed method** (we dogfooded). Every change shipped as one slice = one branch = one PR, and had to pass **three independent gates** before merging:

Gate	What it is	Why it matters
1 · Checks (CI)	ruff, ruff-format, mypy --strict, pytest, import-linter — in CI on every PR	Machine-objective; never skipped
2 · Cross-family	The <i>opposite</i> AI family reviews every slice (Claude leads → Codex reviews, and vice-versa); saved as a YAML artifact	Independent eyes catch what tests can't
3 · Human gate	You merge the PR (branch protection on main)	Final say stays human

By the numbers

16 phases (0–15)	28 pull requests	100+ tests passing	25 cross-family reviews	5 architecture
contracts · 0 violations	5 ADRs (design decisions)			

The roadmap that got us here — 16 phases to v1

	Phase	What it delivered
0 — 1	Constitution + dev env	Repo, package skeleton, boundary contracts, CI, toolchain
2	Domain & ports	Pure domain objects + typed interfaces (the seams)
3	Workflow engine	LangGraph gated spiral — pause/resume at approval gates
4	Persistence	SQLite state + event log + migrations
5	Approval interface	Telegram allowlist + approval idempotency
6 — 7	Worker adapters	Claude Code + Codex CLI wrapped behind one typed port
8	Review protocol	Structured cross-family review + fail-closed enforcement
9	Cost gateway	Budget circuit breakers + provider-key isolation
1 0	Security profile	Credential scrub + default-deny egress allowlist
1 1	Scheduler	Active-slot cap + priority/FIFO + 24h aging
1 2	Observability	Health aggregation + structured JSON logs

1	systemd	Auto-restart units (gateway-first ordering)
3	service	
1	Bootstrap	TalisMan planned its own v1.1 through its own gates
4	project	
1	Release	Honest acceptance accounting against AT-01...AT-20
5	candidate	

The standout moment — the governance caught real bugs

Cross-family review wasn't ceremony. In **S11.01** Codex blocked a genuine cap-bypass bug that had passed every automated check. And in **S15.01** — the release decision itself — Codex blocked the lead (Claude) for **over-grading its own work**, forcing an honest re-grade. A system that catches its own optimism is the whole point.

Honest acceptance picture (AT-01...AT-20)

5 criteria PASS end-to-end (CI + on-disk artifacts) · **10 component-verified** (built and unit-tested; seven were also shown live in today's walkthrough as *prototype/operator evidence* — not reviewed release proof — and harden into PASS as the v1.1-P1 code lands under governance) · **5 waived** to v1.1, each documented and founder-approved on 2026-06-19.

Status	Acceptance tests
PASS (end-to-end: merged + CI/artifacts)	AT-01,02,03 (CI) · AT-09 (review) · AT-20 (spiral)
Component-verified	AT-06,10,11 (unit-tested) · AT-05,07,08,13,14,15,18 (also shown live today as prototype evidence; flip to PASS as v1.1-P1 lands)
Waived to v1.1 (approved 2026-06-19)	AT-04 durable checkpointer · AT-12 retry/jitter · AT-16 retrospective · AT-17 lessons retrieval · AT-19 incident dump

What changed since the last walkthrough

This is the baseline. It captures the full arc: from an empty repository to a coherent, assembled, self-improving orchestrator that has now had every operator capability exercised live in a prototype walkthrough. Future audit packages will diff against this one to show how TalisMan matured.

Part 2 (live command walkthrough) and Part 3 (roadmap ahead) accompany this document. Source records and the full transcript are in the dated package folder.